

Making Legislation

Spatial Theory

Four assumptions:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.

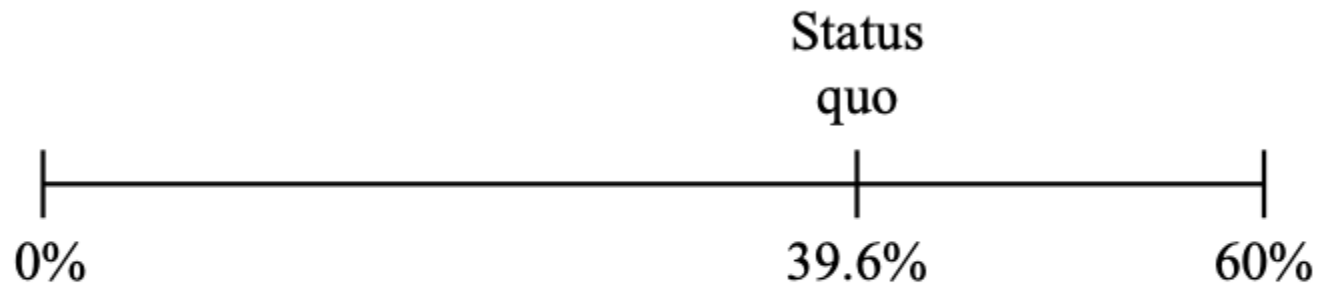
Spatial Theory

Four assumptions:

1. Single dimensional policy space
2. Actors
3. Preference–ideal point
4. Rules

Single Dimensional Space

Top Income Tax Rate



Actors



Mike Huckabee



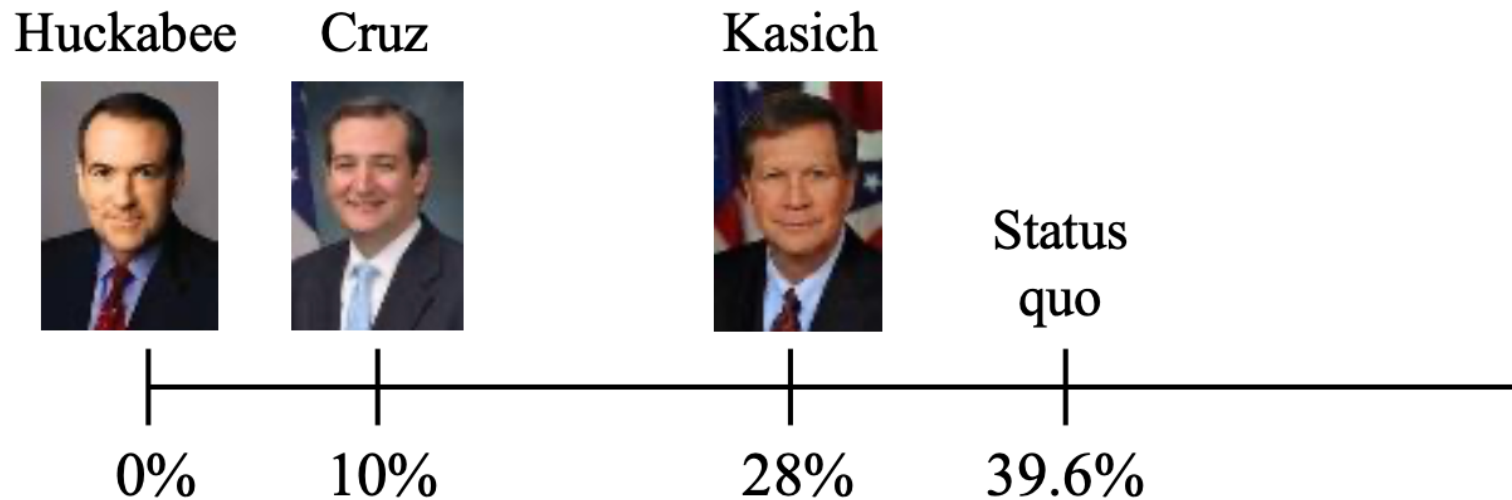
Ted Cruz



John Kasich

Preferences Over the Policy

Where are they on this dimension?



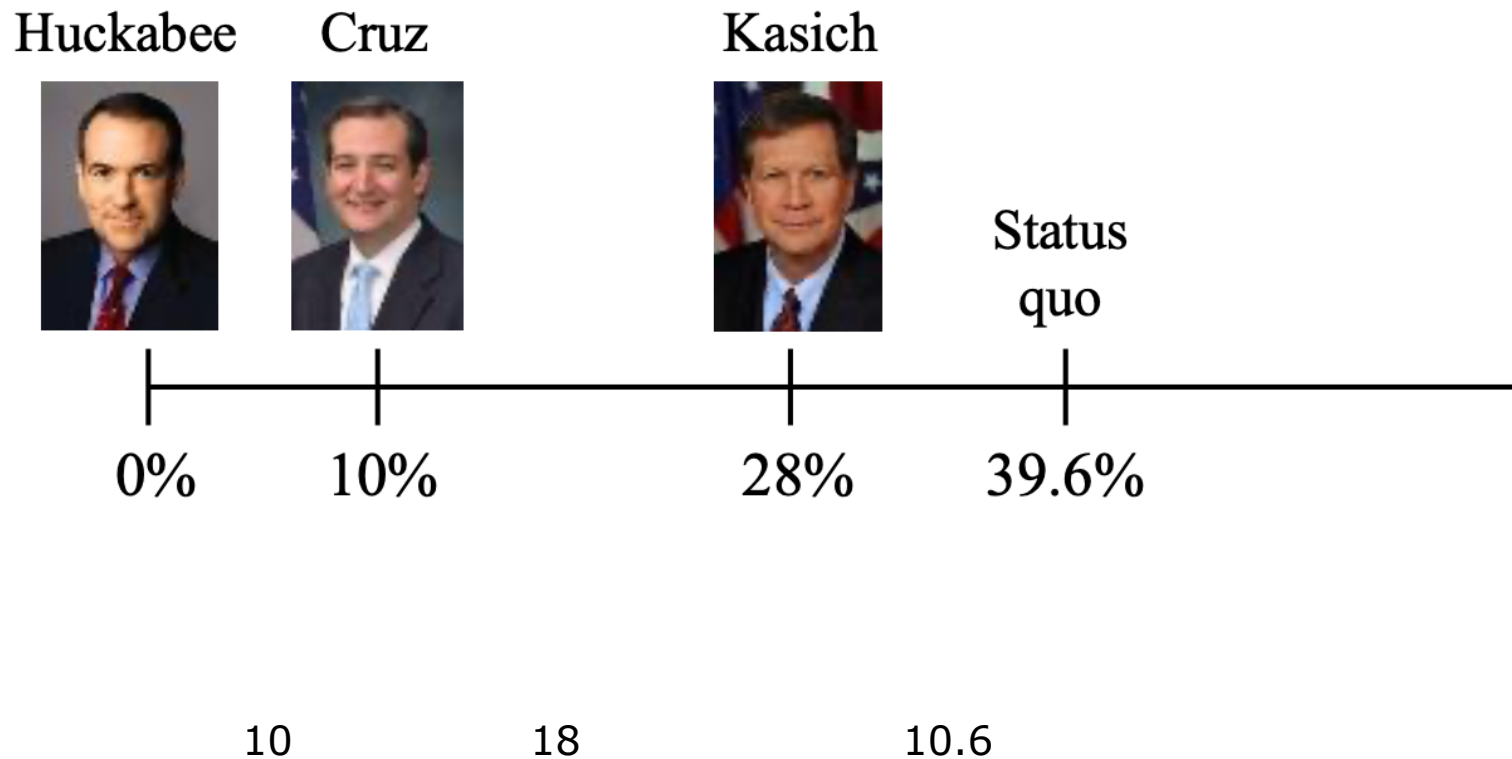
Spatially Ordered Preferences

- Each member prefers options that are closer to their ideal point over options that are more distant

Rules (Starting Example)

1. Open proposals: Any actor can make a proposal.
2. Majority rule: If the majority of actors prefers a proposal to the status quo (SQ) it passes; otherwise SQ prevails

What policy will emerge?



Median voter theorem

Under open proposals and majority rule, the ideal point of the median actor is the stable outcome; it cannot be defeated by any other proposal.

**** EXERCISE ****

Question 1

	A	B	C	D
House	16	32	31	21
Senate	51	4	7	38

Question 1

	A	B	C	D
House	16	32	31	21
Senate	51	4	7	38

Question 2

	A	B	C	D
Committee	35	20	40	5
Senate	51	4	7	38

